powers under the auspices of the UN. The War on Terror, being carried out by the US initially against Afghanistan and thereafter against Iraq, post 9/11, show that the use of military power is still important and its use by the reigning superpower and its allies to the protection of their own interest is the rule of the day. The United Nations is just side-tracked by these powers and, in these current cases, unilateral actions are taken on the basis of the principle of pre-emptive self defence by the states on their own.

The UN has been hijacked by the sole superpower, the United States and it is used by the United States and the West to serve their own interest and solidify their domination over the small and weak states. It is a long way to establish the New International Economic Order or an international system based on the rule of law and greater sharing between the North and the South.

The condition of the Third World has remained unchanged in the post-Cold War scenario. Although the superpower relationships were formulated in the context of the Cold War, with the collapse of the Soviet Union, the United States and the industrialized North continue their old policy of intervention and domination. Only they have modified it to make it more relevant in the current post-Cold War scenario.

The Third World, especially the Middle East, still continues to be the vital interest zone for the West, especially the United States. The first post-Cold War National Security strategy report sent to the US Congress in March 1990, recognized that military power must target the Third World, primarily the Middle East, where the “threats to our interests” that have required force “could not be laid at the Kremlin’s door”.[23] Therefore, the prime concern continued to be the control of the countries of the South.

The domination of South is now ensured not through the use of force but by the use of economic weapons. The international financial regimes such as the IMF, the World Bank and WTO (the Triad), with their policies of structural adjustments, are spreading their tentacles of domination all over the developing South. The other mechanism includes multinational corporations (MNCs) through which the developed West tries to reduce the functions of the Third World